

Since the release of *Avatar* in 3-D, which was shot using Sony's 3-D cameras and solutions, Sony has grabbed the attention of viewers all over the world on the entertainment opportunities of 3-D. Having led the way in the growth of HD, the company is now also leading the way in making 3-D the next great entertainment platform.

Chris Grey, head of broadcast & content creation solutions, business & professional products APAC (BPPA), Sony Electronics APAC, was recently in New Delhi to host Sony TecXpo 2010—a conference and exhibition by Sony for the broadcast and production industry. On the occasion, Grey spoke to Uma Bansal, deputy editor at EFY, about the prospects of high-definition (HD) and 3-D TV in India. Excerpts...

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“For India, mass HD adoption with content will come first”

How does HDTV compare with normal TV?

The resolution of the signal is much higher. That means the quality of the picture is about five times higher than standard definition. So the camera needs much higher specifications in order to record these pictures. The production and transmission also need to be much improved to manage the HD signal.

Most big-screen flat TVs have HD Ready logo, which means they have HDMI inputs and will be able to receive HD signals.

As the HD content is not available in India, is an HDTV set still worth buying?

Well, some people are buying consumer camcorders for recording family events in HD. All the consumer cameras are now HD-capable, so you might want to play pictures back on a big screen through the HDMI connector. Some people are buying PlayStation3 gaming console. You can buy the games in HD. Also when you shoot from still cameras, the resolution is actually much higher than in HD. So it's nice to have a big screen to see the recordings. For movie

content, there are Blu ray DVDs. You can play them through a Blu-ray player or a PlayStation3.

Thus people are relying not just on TV; there are many more activities.

What is preventing content producers from producing HD content?

In order to produce HD content, they need to have a market to cater to. The pattern has been pretty similar around the world. Usually, it's been sports events that have been the leader in content. Then it's the movies, drama and documentaries to follow before finally the regular channels become capable of simultaneous transmission of HD and SD signals.

What are the challenges for rolling out HD in India?

India is an enormous country. I have heard there are 1400 transmitters for people to receive terrestrial transmission. So just changing those is going to be quite a task. Probably a more convenient way is the DTH platform to deliver from the satellite. Providers have announced that this year they will be providing HD channels. Everybody needs to